Ghana Communication Technology University

Department of General Studies
Second Semester Examinations, 2022
Level 100
Evening/Weekend
BIT/BCS/BSE
Course Code: ENGL 174/ENGL 172
Course Title: Study Skills/Communication Skills II

Time: Two and a half hours

This paper is made up of two sections: Section A and Section B. Answer ALL questions in Section A on the Question Paper; Answer ALL questions in Section B in the Answer Booklet provided except Q3(d) that should be answered on the Question Paper.

Date: November 12, 2022. Examination Venue: ..... ID No: .....

Program: .....

Campus (for Satellite campuses only) .....

Section A- Objectives (30 Marks)

Circle the correct answer in INK.

1. Scholarly writing is said to be a science for all the following reasons **except**:
   A. Scholarly writing requires the denunciation of the rule of a topic worthy of scholarly research.
   B. Scholarly writing requires compliance with a scholarly manual.
   C. Scholarly writing requires a clear understanding of the mechanics of writing.
   D. Scholarly writing requires basic adherence to the steps of the scientific method.

2. Mensah Ochinakoo wrote a book, *How to Kiss Unwilling Lady*. Mensah Ochinakoo uses harsh words and unprintable words to depict a situation of unwillingness of a lady to a kiss. As one reads the book, the words used by Mensah Ochinakoo reverberate beyond the text, time and place. What rhetorical situation in writing describes Mensah Ochinakoo's choice of words?
   A. The writer's audience
   B. The writer's purpose
   C. The writer's voice
   D. The occasion

3. Atsu Bismarck was reprimanded by his wife for his infidelity. His wife threatened to seek divorce if he fails to recant. Being remorseful, Atsu Bismarck decided to put together words (written or unwritten) to express his remorsefulness and to promise his wife that he would recant. In this context, what should determine Atsu Bismarck's choice of words?
   A. The purpose
   B. The occasion
   C. The audience
   D. The topic.

4. Adjoa Cynthia Marfo wrote a book titled, *The Art and Science of Academic Writing*. She writes her name as Adjoa Cynthia Marfo, but her surname is Marfo. Her first and middle names are Cynthia and Adjoa, respectively. By convention, in what order should her name be written on the cover and title pages of the book?
   A. Adjoa Cynthia Marfo.
   B. Marfo Adjoa Cynthia
   C. Cynthia Adjoa Marfo
   D. Marfo Cynthia Adjoa

5. Mansa Musa quoted from a particular source and uses ellipsis (…) in parts of the quotation. Mansa Musa's use of the ellipsis in the quotation signified that:
   A. part of the quotation is insignificant and redundant to be used.

B. part of the quotation is made up of Mansa Musa's own words that she inserted into the quotation.
C. part of the quotation has been omitted by Mansa Musa.
D. part of the quotation continues on the next page of Mansa Musa's work.

6. Assume that Michael Agyemang, Akua Deberah, Cecilia Marfo, and Mansa Musa wrote a book, *Criminals in Cassocks*, and published it in 2020. How will the authors and their work be cited in an In-Text APA style using the Latin abbreviation *et al*?
   A. (Agyemang, et al. 2020).
   B. (Agyemang, et. al., 2020).
   C. (Agyemang et al., 2020).
   D. (Agyemang et al, 2020).

7. Learning to work together with classmates in group assignments is important because:
   A. It helps students to read other materials and to socialize to know each other beyond the traits they exhibit in class.
   B. It helps the students to acquire teamwork skills and learn to accept constructive criticism.
   C. It helps students to pick important lessons from their independent studies and to integrate such with the salient lessons provided in class by the instructor.
   D. It helps students to share ideas and help colleagues with reading skills.

8. It is important for a writer to meet the needs of his/her reading audience by:
   A. Knowing the characteristics of his/her readers, recognize, respect, and respond to their needs.
   B. Knowing the characteristics of his/her readers and ignore their needs in the way the content is organized.
   C. Knowing the size of the reading audience and deliberately shift his/her perspectives from a reader to a writer.
   D. Knowing the perspectives of his/her reading audiences and juxtapose them with those of the writer in order to make a blend of the two perspectives in the write-up.

9. All the following are the reasons why it is important for a reader to ask questions about a text when reading **except**:
   A. Asking questions helps to keep the reader focused on the text.
   B. Asking questions would prevent a reader's mind from wandering and/or getting bored due to lack of understanding of the text.
   C. Asking questions of a text helps a reader to overcome or navigate a way out of reading problems, particularly the problem of lack of understanding of the text.
   D. Asking questions about the text when reading helps the reader to undermine the significant aspects of the text that the reader needs to understand.

10. All the following are true of a coherent paragraph **except:**
   A. In a coherent paragraph, each sentence relates clearly to the topic sentence or controlling idea.

B. In a coherent paragraph, each sentence flows smoothly into the next without obvious shifts or jumps, i.e., the sentences be arranged in a clear, logical order, and the transitions should be smooth and natural.
C. A coherent paragraph highlights the ties between old information and new information to make the structure of ideas or arguments clear to the reader.
D. A coherent paragraph is used as means to detect exceedingly short and long sentences that require rewording.

11. Consider the following statements, and point out those that can be said to be good topic sentences.

i. The performance of the Black Stars of Ghana against the Bafana Bafana of South Africa was mixed.
ii. You must make good use of the time available.
iii. Africans are very hospital.
iv. There are many ways to market a presidential candidate.
v. Time heals all wounds.
vi. The micro-economic indicators in Ghana for the 2021 fiscal year are weak for a number of reasons.
vii. Good learning skills are essential in tertiary education in GIMPA.

A. I, II, IV, VI & VI.
B. I, IV, VI & VII.
C. II, III, V & VI.
D. II, IV, VI & VII.

12. Clear writing is important for the following reasons **except:**
A. It demonstrates that the writer's thinking ability about a subject is logical and coherent.
B. It enables the writer to convey to his/her readers in a convincing or persuasive way exactly what the writer wants them to understand.
C. Writer's clear writing skills tell the readers a lot about the writer's ability to read critically and think clearly.
D. Clear writing enables the writer to skip impertinent and pertinent issues and to make digressions from time to time.

13. A writer's work is said to be good if the writer makes a research argument and:
A. lays out the reasons and evidence advanced in support of the argument so that readers can consider/analyse them.
B. imagines questions readers might ask in relation to the argument, reasons and evidence and provides answers to them.
C. builds his/her argument around answers to imagined readers' questions.
D. focuses on evidence and provides a morphology of their logical, cosmological and metaphysical dimensions.

14. Which one of the following sentences has a linking device(s)?
   A. Moreover, Abena and Cynthia are good friends.
   B. Kofi and Mensah are busy working. When they finish, CEO will like to meet them.
   C. On that particular raining day, Tabiri and Okoe did not come to school. As a result, the teach instructed Kofi and Adjoa to lead the class.
   D. All things equal, Gyamfi will link up with Sosu for the meeting tomorrow.

15. All the following are true of a coherent paragraph **except:**
   A. In a coherent paragraph, each sentence relates clearly to the topic sentence or controlling idea.
   B. In a coherent paragraph, each sentence flows smoothly into the next without obvious shifts or jumps, i.e., the sentences be arranged in a clear, logical order, and the transitions should be smooth and natural.
   C. A coherent paragraph also highlights the ties between old information and new information to make the structure of ideas or arguments clear to the reader.
   D. In a coherent paragraph, all the sentences are long, and there the entire paragraph can fill a page due the high number of the linking devices.

16. Consider the following short passage, and determine its appropriate summary.
   The itsy-bitsy spider climbed up the water spout. Down came the rain and washed the spider out. Up came the sun and dried up all the rain. And the itsy-bitsy spider climbed up the spout again.

   A. A notorious spider was nearly washed away by the rain.
   B. A spider was going up and down when it started running, and then later the sun shone.
   C. A spider fell but got up again.
   D. Had it not been the sun, a spider that was washed away by the rain would have died.

17. Consider the following passage and determine its appropriate summary.
   A humpty dumpty egg sat on a wall. The humpty dumpty egg had a great fall. The egg was broken and all the king's horses and all the king's men couldn't put humpty dumpty egg together again.
   A. An egg fell due to its sheer weight and size.
   B. An egg fell and was irreparably broken.
   C. An egg, which was being prepared for humpty dumpty, fell and broke into pieces.
   D. An egg, which was placed on a wall, fell and broke despite attempts by the king's horses and men to prevent it from falling.

18. Reading strategies are significant because:
A. They help readers and writers to determine how the reading of a text should be done, and what readers should do before and when reading a text.
B. They help readers to manipulate a text to their advantage and extrapolate the contents of the text in the course of reading.

C. They help readers understand, connect to, and determine the importance of what they are reading.
D. They help readers to visualize, to ignore asking questions about, and to undermine reading between the lines of what they read.

19. Which of the following are correction strategies that one needs to utilize to figure out what went wrong in reading?
    i. The reader should re-read the text if he/she did not grasp or fully understand it after previous reading(s).
    ii. The reader should underline unknown words and important points in the text to help him/her figure out what the text is about.
    iii. Where the understanding of a text is problematic due to some unknown words, the reader should use a dictionary to look up for the meanings of the words to help his/her understanding of the text.
    iv. In some cases, it is necessary for the reader to read the text aloud to himself/herself – either in the form of a 'silent loud reading' or a 'noisy loud reading' – to help stimulate understanding.
    v. It is imperative for a reader to discard the text entirely when he/she finds it is extremely difficult to get an understanding of a text after making strenuous personal efforts.
    A. All except II and IV.
    B. All except II and III.
    C. All except IV only.

20. Passive readers of a textbook read as if everything a book contains is equally important; active readers:
    A. begin reading by identifying the thesis of the text, read with the author's thesis in mind, and determine the major points used to support the thesis.
    B. begin reading the textbook by perusing the introduction and looking for arguments that undermine the thesis of the writer.
    C. provide a list of items to consider before reading, identify the writer's thesis and provide a catalogue of criticisms of the writer's thesis.
    D. read the introduction, peruse the table of contents, conclusion, and use the index as a guide to read the textbook.

21. "Many students fail their examination in the universities. Usually, university students would prefer to wait till examinations are due before they study. There is no doubt that examinations in general are difficult to write. The few university students that study hard always pass their examinations, no matter how difficult the questions are." What is the topic sentence in the short passage?
    A. Many students fail their examination in the universities.
    B. Usually, university students would prefer to wait till examinations are due before they study.
    C. There is no doubt that examinations in general are difficult to write.
    The few university students that study hard always pass their examinations, no matter how difficult the questions are.

A. By and large, it helps students to succeed in class, particularly in the course.
B. Keeping with reading course materials is significant because it will give the student the background knowledge, which he/she needs to understand lectures.
C. Reading course materials will also make the student to be active in class, especially in class discussions that contribute to the final grade in a course.
D. Reading course materials is likely to impede the progress of a student in class.

Section B [30 marks]

Answer ALL QUESTIONS in this Section in the Answer Booklet provided except Question 3(d).
NB: Answer Question 3(d) on the Question Paper.

QUESTION 1 [6 marks]

In not more than twenty (20) words, state the theses of the following abstracts/passages. Each thesis should be **strong**, **precise** and **researchable**.

Question 1 (a) [2 marks]
Our paper seeks to delineate the lived experiences, challenges and coping strategies of female police officers in a District Command of the Ghana Police Service in Accra-Ghana. The qualitative in-depth interview method was used to select 20 female police officers from five police stations purposively with in-depth interviews as the data collection instrument. The paper concluded that, the respondents had cherished experiences as policewomen such as the respect, recognition and assistance from the public. However, they experienced police operational challenges including intimidation by senior officers, challenge of combining work with family responsibilities, gender stereotypes and discriminations as well as occupational stress. The paper recommended, among others, the need for a quota for female recruitment and periodic seminars on stress management and coping strategies.

Question 1 (b) [2 marks]

Over the past four decades, Northern Ghana has been in a state of atrophy and turmoil due to intermittent conflicts. To combat these conflicts, the government and the security agencies deployed security personnel to the conflict zones to prevent conflagration and escalation, to "engineer" ceasefires, and to maintain law and order. Strategies employed by the security agencies to combat conflicts in Northern Ghana were varied, but, in general, the imposition of curfews, undertaking patrols, mounting surveillance and checkpoints, "engineering" ceasefire pacts, and undertaking swoops, were utilized by the security agencies. Scholars have critiqued the mechanics of security measures applied to conflicts in Northern Ghana, noting the measures and evaluating their successes and failures.